



Mandar Marulkar
Chief Information Security
Officer,
KPIT Cummins

We do have a restriction on the usage of camera phones, but it's limited to our Offshore Development Centres (ODCs) only—mainly in the financial and voice services section.

Moreover, the same request also came in from our customers as they were concerned about the security of their data in view of employees carrying camera phones. In order to make them comfortable and ensure protection of data, we found it essential to impose such a ban. And employees extended their co-operation keeping in mind the sensitive nature of the work. While we had informed all employees about not using the camera phone at work, we made it compulsory only a few months ago. They were given a month's time to make alternative arrangements.

We inform employees about this ban during the induction programme and have even put up posters all over the office indicating the ban. Still, if some employees carry camera phones, they have to deposit the phones with the security and collect them while leaving. They can receive personal calls on the office phone. We have faith in our employees and expect them to follow the rules. In case of a violation, we shall deal with the individual as per our policies.

At the very least, it's necessary for organisations to have such a policy. A camera phone has much scope for misuse than just transferring data over the Internet. It is always better to take preventive measures.

OTING!



Susir Kumar
CEO,
Intelenet Global Services

Camera phones are banned on the operations floor, but are allowed in other areas of our company. Any person entering the operations area has to follow this rule. We have always banned camera phones on our work floors, and reinforced our stand in July 2005.

Even our employees responded co-operatively to this decision. Data security and client confidentiality have always been an intrinsic part of our policy. Banning camera phones is just one of the several procedures we follow to protect customer sensitive information.

Our employees have been inculcated with a high level of awareness on the subject of information security. When we implemented the ban, employees were given a three-week notice. We have nearly 80 CCTVs installed in key locations and several digital video recorders that constantly monitor and capture events. The ban was just another precaution to prevent the occurrence of data frauds and thefts.



Manju Nichani
Principal,
K C College, Mumbai

At KC College, usage of camera phones and all other cell phones within classrooms, labs, seminars halls and library is prohibited. However, students can use the phones if they are in the canteen or once they step out of the college.

It was necessary to implement such a ban, because cell phones are a major cause of distraction. Students were found sending messages to each other even during lectures thus interrupting the entire class. Professors are also not allowed to use cell phones in restricted areas. Students come to the college to study and not to answer phone calls. In case of an emergency, their parents can always contact the college.

If any student is found using a cell phone in the restricted areas, it is confiscated by the authorities and returned only after a few days with a verbal warning. Classrooms are now more peaceful, and students and professors are no longer disturbed. I think all educational institutions should implement a ban on cell phones because it amounts to unnecessary disturbance in the study area."

*As told to Preethi Chamikutty
(preethi_chamikutty@thinkdigit.com)*